



Data Classification

Name:		Grade:	
Date completed:		Approved by:	
Valid for:		Signature:	

Data Classification

Match the personnel to the relevant data as per their level of accessibility.



Headteacher



Bursar



Office Manager



IT Manager

**Finance
Confidential**

**Highly
Confidential**

**Project-Internal/
Restricted**

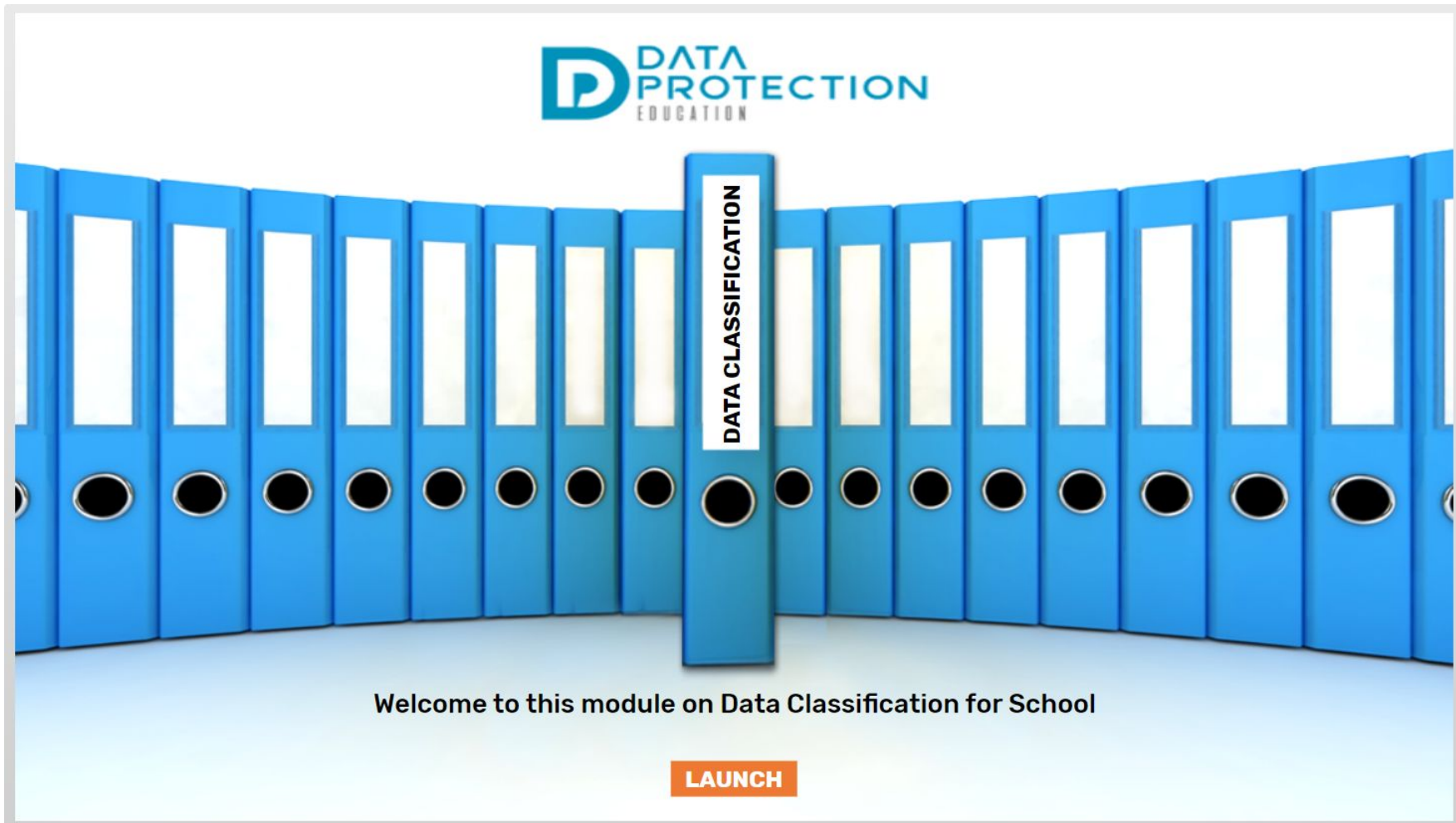
**Employee files
Confidential**

Data Classification

Match the personnel to the relevant data as per their level of accessibility.

Personnel	Data Category	Access Level
Headteacher	Finance Confidential	Bursar
Man on phone	Highly Confidential	
Woman with arms crossed	Project-Internal/Restricted	IT Manager
Man with laptop	Employee files Confidential	Office Manager

Data Classification



Data Classification

Learning objectives

In this module we will discuss:

- The importance of data classification
- Levels of classification of data
- Data labelling and handling
- Best practices



Data Classification

Data classification

Data classification is the process of classifying and organising data into different categories to ensure its confidentiality, integrity and availability.

Data classification is based on the level of sensitivity of data or exposure to businesses if data security is compromised.

Data classification involves tagging/labelling soft as well as hard data.
This helps you track and locate and protect sensitive information.



Data Classification

Levels of classification

Every organisation has its own security policy which prescribes different levels of data classification. Based on the importance of the data and its effect on the company, data can generally be classified into three levels.

Public

Private

Confidential

→ Click each level of data classification to learn more.

Data Classification

The image shows a digital interface for data classification. At the top left, a dark blue header contains the text "Levels of classification". Below this, a large dark blue area with a circuit-like pattern serves as a background. On the left, a semi-transparent grey box contains the text: "Every organisation prescribes different levels of data classification. Based on the information on the company, it is divided into three levels of classification." In the center, a white modal window with a blue header titled "Level 1 : Public" is open. The modal contains two orange square bullet points. To the right of the modal is a 3D illustration of a server rack. Navigation arrows (back and forward) are visible on the left and right sides of the main interface area. At the bottom left, a small orange arrow points to the text "Click each level of data classification to learn more."

Levels of classification

Every organisation prescribes different levels of data classification. Based on the information on the company, it is divided into three levels of classification.

Level 1 : Public

- Easily accessible to everyone including non-employees and general public
- Examples: pamphlets, marketing, brochures, press releases, newsletters

→ Click each level of data classification to learn more.

Data Classification

The screenshot shows a digital interface titled "Levels of classification" in the top left corner. A central pop-up window titled "Level 2 : Private" with a close button (X) in the top right corner is displayed. This window contains a bulleted list of details about Level 2 data. To the left of the pop-up, a semi-transparent text box explains that every organization prescribes different classification levels based on the information and its comparison into three levels. At the bottom of the interface, a navigation bar includes a right-pointing arrow and the text "Click each level of data classification to learn more." The background of the interface features a dark blue theme with circuit-like patterns and a 3D server rack on the right side.

Levels of classification

Level 2 : Private

- Private information may be accessible only to department level users or project team members
- Private information is accessible to authorised users only and breach of confidential information could result in monetary loss, Legal issues, Loss of competitive advantage, client related legal issues, breach of contractual terms
- Examples: finance data, HR data on network folders, project specific data, passwords, student data, parent data, financial reports, salary related data

Every organisation prescribes different classification levels. Based on the information and its comparison into three levels.

→ Click each level of data classification to learn more.

Data Classification

The screenshot shows a digital interface titled "Levels of classification" in the top left corner. A central pop-up window with a blue header and a close button (X) displays the details for "Level 3 : Confidential". The background of the interface features a dark blue grid pattern and a 3D illustration of a server rack on the right. Navigation arrows (left and right) are visible on the sides, and a top-right corner contains a circular refresh icon and a 3x3 grid icon. A text box on the left side of the interface provides context about organizational data classification levels.

Levels of classification

Level 3 : Confidential

- Confidential information contains information that if misused or compromised can cause severe damage to organisations reputation, espionage, strategic objectives, finances, and could result in long lasting legal risks
- Examples: safeguarding data, examination data

Every organisation prescribes different levels of data classification. Based on the importance of the information and the comparison of the risk into three levels.

→ Click each level of data classification to learn more.

Data Classification

Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of confidential data.



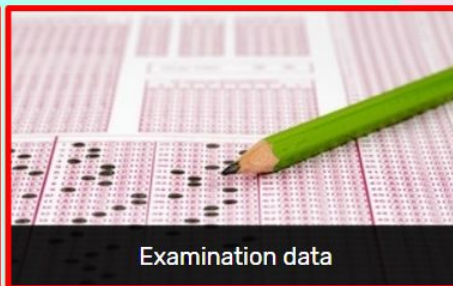
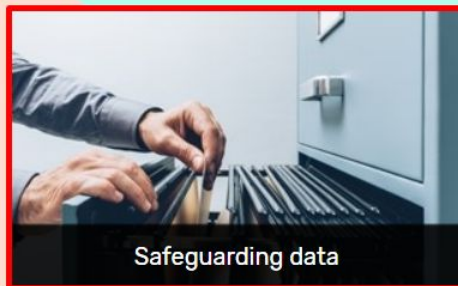
SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of confidential data.



SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification

→ Select which of the following images are examples of confidential data.

Feedback

Perfect!

Some of the examples of confidential data are:

- Safeguarding data
- Examination data



CONTINUE

Data Classification

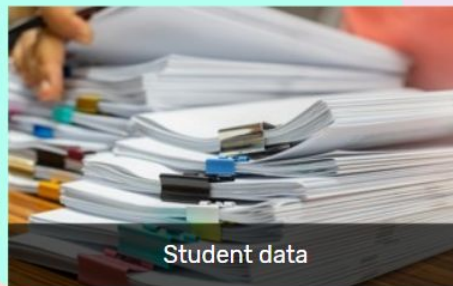
Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of private data.



Designs and trademark



Student data



Network design



Parent information



HR data



Employee communications

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Data Classification

Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of private data.



SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification

→ Select which of the following images are examples of private data.

Feedback

You were almost there.

Some of the examples of private data are:

- Designs and trademark
- Student data
- HR data
- Parent information
- Financial reports
- Employee communications

X

CONTINUE

Data Classification

Levels of classification



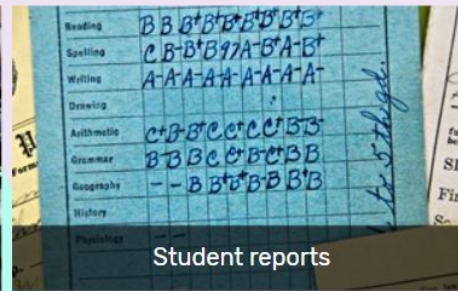
→ Select which of the following images are examples of school private data.



Policies and procedures



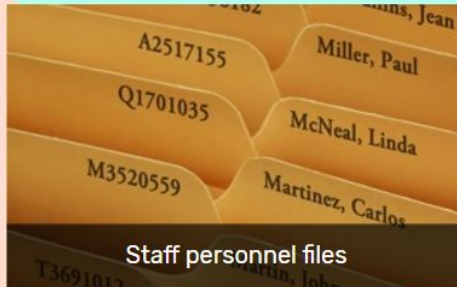
Lesson plans



Student reports



Strategic school staffing plans



Staff personnel files



Employee communications

SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification

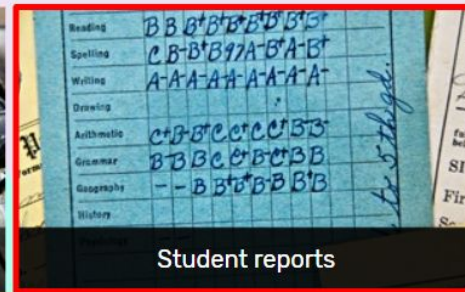
→ Select which of the following images are examples of school private data.



Policies and procedures



Lesson plans



Student reports



Strategic school staffing plans



Staff personnel files



Employee communications

SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification

→ Select which of the following images are examples of school private data.

Feedback

Perfect!

Some of the examples of school private data are:

- Student reports
- Strategic school staffing plans
- Staff personnel files
- Employee communications



CONTINUE

Data Classification

Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of public data.



School website



Development plans



News articles



Banking transactions



Advertisements



School promotions

SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification



→ Select which of the following images are examples of public data.



School website



Development plans



News articles



Banking transactions



Advertisements



School promotions

SUBMIT

Data Classification

Levels of classification

→ Select which of the following images are examples of public data.

Feedback

Perfect!

Some of the examples of public data are:

- School Website
- News Articles
- Advertisements
- School Promotions



CONTINUE

Data Classification

Data labelling

Data labels are used to identify different data classifications.

Data labelling is the first step towards setting up data handling rules.

Labelling of information is usually the responsibility of the data/information owner

Data labelling:

- Helps to limit access
- Supports mechanisms controlling access privileges
- Reduces costs by avoiding the need to secure all data to the highest level



Data Classification

Data handling

- Data handling is the process of ensuring that data is transmitted, archived or discarded in a safe and secure manner
- Data handling involves creating rules on how to protect information depending upon its level of sensitivity
- This includes rules about storing and forwarding specific information
- These rules are different for each level of data classification



Example:

Confidential information must be encrypted while in transit or at database storage and must be stored in lock and key when not attended. Whereas same level of protection is not required for public information

Data Classification

Best practices



- 01 Classify and label data as per data classification guidelines
- 02 Allow only need based access to sensitive information
- 03 Store your department level information as per the data classification guidelines
- 04 Always password protect confidential information while sending it as an email attachment
- 05 Use email encryption for transferring highly confidential information
- 06 Never leave highly confidential, and confidential information unattended on your desk in any format i.e. physical and/or virtual
- 07 Ensure highest level data security (including encryption, if strictly required) when transferring documents through portable media devices
- 08 Use paper shredders to dispose off highly confidential information when no longer needed
- 09 Use trusted authorities as a medium of courier for sending your confidential data. Avoid using third party couriers for sending highly confidential information

Data Classification

Best practices

For transferring hard copies of documents the following precautions must be taken:

- If posting documents, ask for a return acknowledgement receipt
- Make use of cover pages
- Use tamper evident envelopes



Data Classification

Summary

Data classification involves sorting data according to its sensitivity and its impact in case of disclosure.

The three levels of classification are:

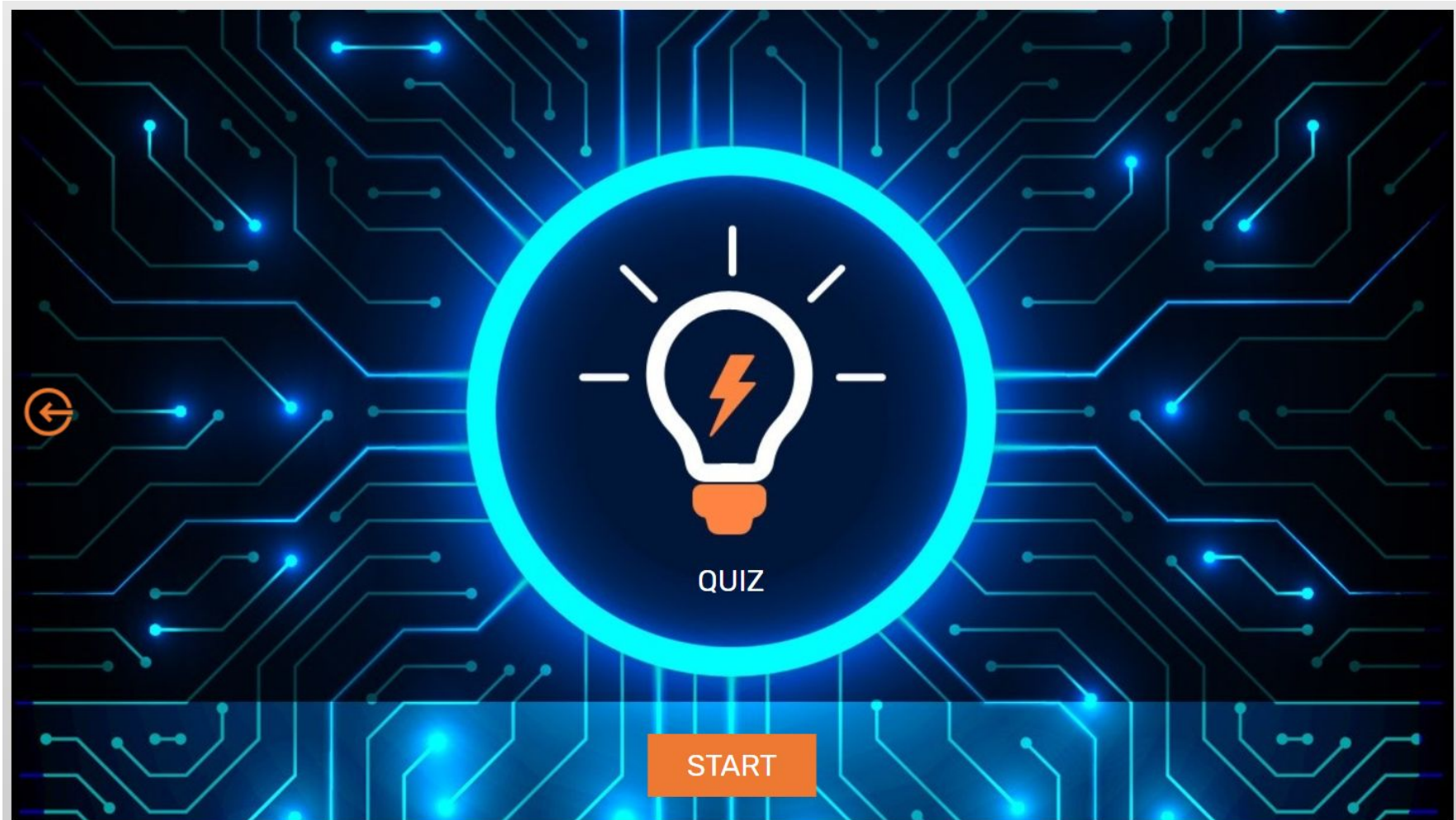
- Public
- Private
- Confidential

Classified data must be easily identifiable. This is achieved through data labelling. Labelling also helps to enforce access control mechanisms.

The rules for storage, transfer and disposal are together known as Data Handling rules. These rules differ for every level of classification.



Data Classification



Data Classification

 Arrange the following documents according to their respective classification level
Drag the correct document to its respective classification level in the second column

Safeguarding data	Drop content here	Unclassified Public Data
School plans	Drop content here	Personal Restricted Data
Parent emails	Drop content here	School Confidential Data
School newsletters	Drop content here	Highly Confidential Data

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Data Classification

Rohan receives an email from his HR department regarding the updated data handling policy and procedures. He has been asked to classify his data as per the policy. While organising his data, he finds a few documents in his locker. Which of the following steps should be followed by Rohan in order to abide with the policy of the organisation?

- ☐ File correctly any documents still required with the correct department. Securely destroy any records no longer required
- ☐ Discard all data that is not a part of the policy
- ☐ Transfer the unwanted data to his colleague over the network
- ☐ Take a print out of all the required documents and mark it as restricted and store it in the locker

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Data Classification

Ada is a new employee, and has joined St John's School as an Admin Assistant in the Head Office. She has been requested to send her personal details by the Human Resources. Which of the following methods is a secured technique of data transmission?

- ☐ Send via personal email as an email attachment
- ☐ Send using an encrypted email service
- ☐ Send the information details via fax or SMS
- ☐ Add to a shared folder on the network or cloud storage

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Data Classification

Ayesha is senior-level employee of the University who oversees the lifecycle of one or more sets of Institutional Data. Which of the following responsibilities should be performed by her?

- ☐ Assign appropriate labels to the data as per its level of sensitivity
- ☐ Set standards and procedures for handling data
- ☐ Set access controls to restrict access to the information
- ☐ Discourage employees from using PIN protected documents and encrypted emails

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Data Classification

Which of the following scenarios depict the correct method of handling information?

- ☐ Phil sends over some documents to Dan after confirming Dan's address and affixing the company's standard cover pages to the document set
- ☐ Susan forgets some important documents in the company's cafeteria

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Data Classification



You have successfully completed this
module on Data Classification

EXIT